

UNIVERSITY OF GHANA

DEPARTMENT OF TEACHER EDUCATION

SCHOOL OF EDUCATION AND LEADERSHIP

STUDENT REFLECTIVE JOURNAL

YEAR 2 SEM 2

STUDENT NAME: SOLOMON KOFIE

STUDENT I.D. NUMBER: 22303584

ACADEMIC YEAR: 2025/2026

DATE OF SUBMISSION: 1ST NOVEMBER, 2026

YEAR TWO SCHOOL OBSERVATION

SCHOOL PROFILE

NAME OF SCHOOL: BUTUMAGYEBU S.T.M.A PRIMARY/JHS

NAME OF LEAD MENTOR : BARBARA ARTHUR

NAME OF MENTOR: JOSEPH SLEE QUAYSON

NAMES OF OTHER STAFF MEMBERS



Enrolment by class and sex

Class	Boys	Girls	Total	SEN
Basic 1	14	13	27	0
Basic 2	13	12	25	0
Basic 3	10	10	20	1
Basic 4	23	14	37	1
Basic 5	15	17	32	0
Basic 6	11	23	34	0
JHS 1	21	20	41	0
JHS 2	19	25	44	0
JHS 3	17	26	43	1

SCHOOL PROFILE

SCHOOL FACILITIES (e. g football field, toilet, office space, tennis court, buildings etc.

Classroom block, washroom, office space, playground

BRIEF HISTORY OF THE SCHOOL

Butumagyebu S.T.M.A Primary and JHS was built in 1969 in the Ketan-Sekondi District by Dr. Kofi Abrefa Busia. The school was initially a wooden temporary structure for Nursery pupils only. In 1968, the land was a coconut farm. The elders of the community, namely Egya Baake, Egya Basintwe and the Chief of the land, Nana Koie I, pleaded for the school to be built in the town. The school officially commenced in 1969. The first Headteacher appointed to manage the school was Mr. F.T. Mensah, with the motto "Gye Nyame". As time went on, the school became very effective in academics and sports, which encouraged parents to enroll their wards.

Stakeholders collaborating with the school

The school works with several stakeholders who support learners' education and welfare. These include parents and guardians, the Parent Association (PA), the School Management Committee (SMC), the Ghana Education Service (GES), the District Education Directorate, the District Assembly, traditional leaders, community members, past students and non-governmental organisations. Their support includes providing resources, maintaining school facilities, monitoring attendance and helping address learners' needs.

Classroom rule	Why this rule is important	How the rule is enforced	consequences if broken
Come to class on time.	It helps lessons begin promptly and reduces disruption.	The teacher reminds learners of the timetable, records lateness where necessary and speaks privately with repeat offenders.	The learner may receive a reminder, complete missed work or have the matter discussed with a parent/guardian if it continues.
Raise your hand and wait for permission to speak.	It allows everyone to contribute and prevents learners from speaking over one another.	The teacher models the rule, gives turns fairly and reminds learners when they interrupt.	The learner is reminded and may be asked to wait until others have had a turn.
Respect teachers and classmates.	Respect creates a safe classroom where learners feel comfortable asking questions and making mistakes.	The teacher models respectful language, addresses unkind behaviour promptly and encourages learners to resolve disagreements	The teacher discusses the behaviour with the learner and uses appropriate restorative or school-approved consequences.

		calmly.	
Keep the classroom clean and take care of school property.	A clean classroom supports health and helps learning materials last longer.	Learners follow a cleaning routine, use bins where available and handle books and equipment carefully.	The learner helps put things right, cleans the affected area or replaces/repairs damage according to school policy and family circumstances.

TOPIC 10.5: Teacher professionalism

Days of visit: Tuesday and Wednesday

Dates of visit: 15th September,2026/ 16th September,2026/ 13th October,2026

Activity 10.5.1

SRJ Task: Observation and recording (audio/video) of some teachers' behaviours, attitudes, knowledge and practices in the classroom and the wider school life

Comments on diverse behaviours of teachers you observed

During my observation, I noticed that teachers showed different professional behaviours. Some prepared learners for the lesson, explained ideas step by step, asked questions and moved around the classroom to check learners' understanding. Teachers who encouraged questions and praised effort helped learners participate more confidently. I also observed the importance of punctuality, patience, clear instructions and fair treatment. When learners became distracted, calm reminders and clear expectations were more helpful than shouting. A teacher's attitude, communication and preparation can affect both classroom discipline and the quality of learning.

What were your challenges during activity 10.5.1?

One challenge was trying to observe the lesson carefully while also recording useful details without interrupting teaching and learning. It was not always easy to distinguish a teacher's usual practice from behaviour that happened only in that particular lesson. I also had to be careful not to judge a teacher without considering the class size, available resources and learners' needs. Recording or taking pictures can raise privacy concerns, so permission and

the school's rules were followed. In future, I would use a simple observation checklist and write factual notes immediately after the lesson.

Activity 10.5.2:

Playback of recorded and online audios/videos of expected behaviours, attitudes, knowledge and practices of a professional teacher

State at least three (3) acceptable teacher qualities that were not identified in activity 7.5.2

1. **Reflectiveness**: a professional teacher reviews lessons and uses feedback to improve future teaching.
2. **Adaptability**: a teacher adjusts explanations, examples and activities when learners have different abilities or do not understand the first explanation.
3. **Confidentiality**: a teacher protects learners' personal information and discusses sensitive matters only with the appropriate people.
4. **Collaboration:** a teacher works respectfully with colleagues, parents and other stakeholders to support learners.

In your opinion, how would an unacceptable behaviour observed from the playback influence the teachers' work?

Unacceptable behaviour weaken learners' trust and make the classroom less supportive. For example, favouritism may cause some learners to feel ignored, while insults or humiliation may make learners afraid to ask questions or participate. Poor preparation can waste lesson time and lead to misunderstandings. Frequent lateness or failure to keep promises can also set a poor example. Such behaviour may affect learners' confidence, achievement and attitude towards school, and it can damage the teacher's relationship with parents and colleagues. Teachers therefore need to reflect on their conduct, accept constructive feedback and follow professional standards.

Activity 10.5.3: Hold reflective/feedback sessions to consolidate understanding of teacher professionalism

Identify several professional traits you found interesting which you will focus on in your professional practices and give reasons.

The professional traits I found most important were patience, fairness, punctuality, preparation, confidentiality and willingness to learn. I want to be patient because learners understand concepts at different rates and may need more than one explanation. Fairness is important because every learner deserves respect and a genuine opportunity to participate, regardless of background or ability. Punctuality and preparation help me use lesson time well and present content clearly. Confidentiality protects learners' dignity and

personal information. Finally, I want to seek feedback and reflect on my lessons because teaching requires continuous learning and improvement.

TOPIC 10.6: Development of professional teaching Portfolio

Day of visit: Tuesday and Wednesday

Date of visit: 14th,19th and 20th October, 2026

Activity 10.6.1

SRJ Task: Discussion and review of personal teaching philosophy with tutors, mentors and STS partner

Record your reviewed personal teaching philosophy statement taking a clue from the discussions you have had with your STS partner and mentor on beliefs and values in teaching and learning.

My teaching philosophy is that every learner can make progress when teaching is purposeful, inclusive and responsive to their needs. My role as a teacher is not only to explain content but also to guide learners to ask questions, think critically, practise skills and apply what they learn to everyday life. I believe learners understand better when lessons connect with their experiences and include discussion, practical activities and examples. I will create a respectful classroom where learners feel safe to contribute and where differences in ability, language, background and learning pace are considered. I will assess learners regularly, give constructive feedback, work with colleagues and families, and reflect on my teaching so that I can keep improving.

Identify the similarities and differences between your Year One and reviewed personal teaching philosophy statements and give reasons for the differences.

My Year One and reviewed teaching philosophy statements are similar because both recognise the teacher's responsibility to help learners understand and achieve their potential. Both also value a positive classroom environment and meaningful learning. The reviewed statement is more detailed about inclusion, different learning needs, learner participation, assessment, feedback and collaboration with parents and colleagues. These differences reflect my growing understanding that teaching involves more than delivering information: I must also check whether learners are learning, adapt my methods when necessary and reflect on the effectiveness of my practice.

Activity 10.6.2

Development of a template for professional teaching portfolio (consider inclusivity and diversity)

Record what you shared with your STS partner and mentor regarding the importance of developing a template for professional teaching portfolio.

I shared that a portfolio template helps a student teacher organise evidence of professional growth in a clear and consistent way. It makes it easier to find artefacts, connect them to teaching standards and show how feedback has influenced practice. A useful template should include a personal statement, teaching philosophy, reflective journals, lesson plans, assessment samples, feedback from mentors, records of professional meetings and evidence of inclusive teaching. Each item should have a short description, date and explanation of what it demonstrates. The portfolio should be updated regularly, protect learners' privacy and include only photographs, recordings or learner work for which appropriate permission has been obtained.

Activity 10.6.3

Collection, compilation and filing of artefacts, such as pictures, videos, audio tapes, reports from small scale classroom enquiry (4 learners), reviewed personal teaching philosophy, entries in the SRJ, etc.

Record all the artefacts collected from the school for the compilation of your professional teaching Portfolio.

1. Student Reflection Journal (SRJ)
2. Evidence of extra curricular activities
3. Sample Lesson plans
4. Teaching and Learning Resources (TLRs)
5. Sample class exercise, quizzes, class test and so on

Reviewed Personal Teaching Philosophy

My teaching philosophy is learner-centred. I believe learners understand concepts better when they take part in discussions, ask and answer questions, work with others, observe examples and practise what they have learned. I aim to explain ideas in simple language, connect lessons to learners' experiences and use teaching and learning materials where possible.I believe practical examples, demonstrations, problem-solving activities and guided practice makes abstract concepts easier to understand.

I value patience, fairness, respect, honesty, responsibility, inclusion and collaboration. I endeavour to create a classroom where learners feel safe to contribute, where differences in ability are recognised, and where every learner is treated with dignity. I also recognise that effective teaching requires preparation, good classroom management, continuous reflection and a willingness to receive feedback. My goal is to keep improving my professional skills so that I can support learners academically and socially.

THANK YOU

Thank you for taking the time to review my teaching internship portfolio. This portfolio represents my learning, reflection and continuing commitment to professional growth.

CONTACT

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FAVOURITE QUOTE

“Teaching is the one profession that creates all other professions.”